

Lab 7 – Create Topics

Lab Overview

In this lab, you will create your first topic in Microsoft Copilot Studio. Topics are the foundation of a copilot and represent specific conversation areas or business processes. By creating a topic, you enable the copilot to respond to user requests related to a particular subject.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lab, you will be able to:

- * Create a new topic in Copilot Studio.
- * Understand the structure of a topic.
- * Add conversation messages to a topic.
- * Test a topic using the built-in test panel.
- * Understand how topics help organize conversations.

Business Scenario

You are working for Contoso Learning Services, a company that provides training programmes to employees.

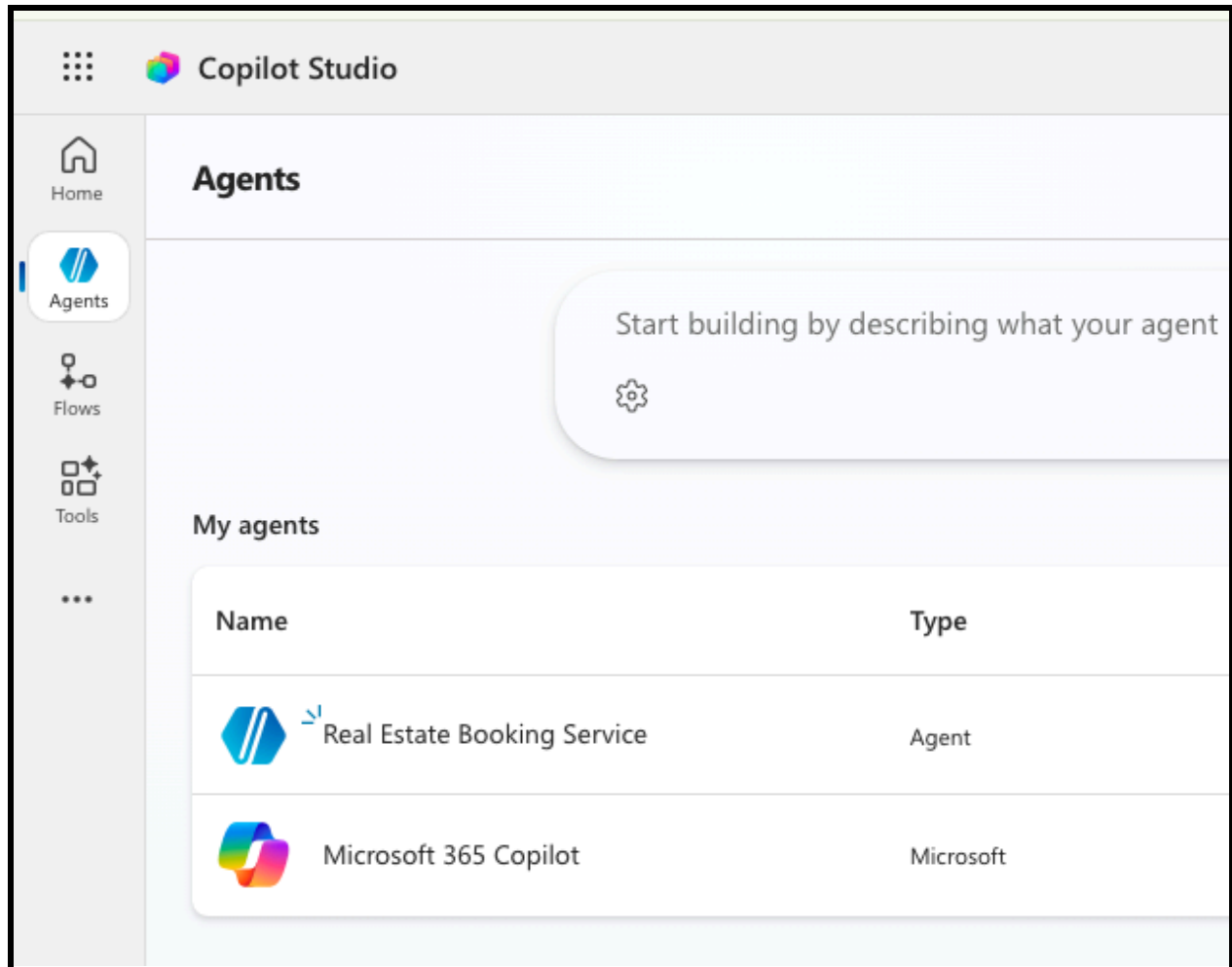
Employees often ask questions such as:

- * How can I register for a training course?
- * What learning programmes are available?
- * How do I access certification training?

To help employees get quick answers, you will create a topic called "Training Information".

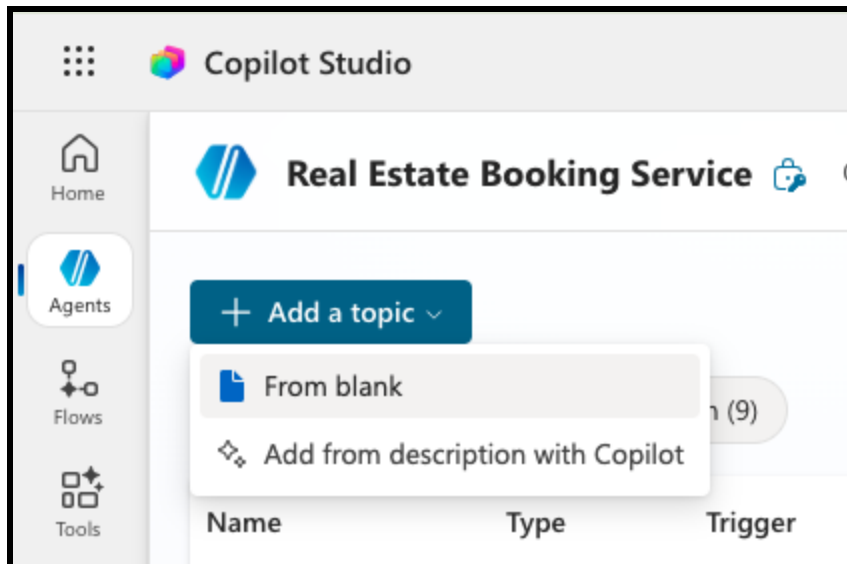
Task 1: - Create a topic from blank

1. Navigate to the Copilot Studio portal <https://copilotstudio.microsoft.com> and ensure you are in the appropriate environment.
2. Select **Agents** from the left navigation pane.
3. Select the any **agent** you created in the earlier lab.



Task 2: Create a Topic from Blank

1. Select the **Topics** tab.
2. Select **+ Add a topic** and select **From blank**.
3. Choose **From blank**.



4. Click on **details**

{X} variables Topic checker **Details** More **Save**

Topic details ×

Topic details Input Output

Name * ⓘ
Training Registration

Description ⓘ
Enter a description

Model display name ⓘ
Training Registration

Model description ⓘ
Enter a description

[Learn more](#)

Ask the user before running this tool ⓘ
Off ☐

Status ⓘ
On ☒

Created

5. Enter:
 - **Topic Name:** Training Registration
 - **Description:** Handles training registration requests from employees.
6. Select **Save**.

Expected Outcome: A blank authoring canvas appears.

Task 3: Add Trigger Phrases

Add the following trigger phrases:

- Register for training
- Enroll in a course
- Sign me up for training
- I want training

Save the topic.

Test: Type one of the trigger phrases in the Test Agent pane.

Task 4: Greet the User

1. Add a **Send a message** node.
2. Enter:

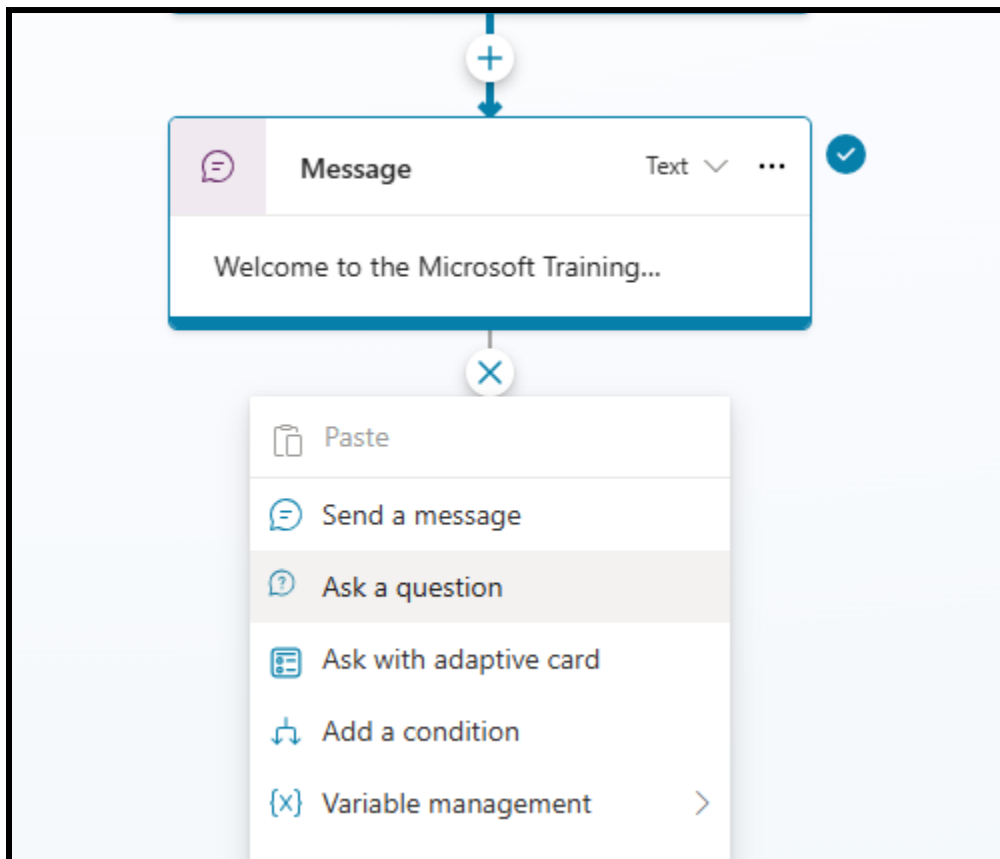
Welcome to the Microsoft Training Registration Assistant.:-)

Save the topic.

Expected Outcome: User receives the welcome message.

Task 5: Capture Employee Name

1. Add **Ask a Question**.



2. Question:

What is your name?

The image shows a configuration window for a question. At the top, there's a title bar with a question icon, the word 'Question', and a 'Text' dropdown. Below this is a rich text editor toolbar with buttons for bold (B), italic (I), bulleted list, numbered list, link ({x}), and formula (fx). The text input area contains 'What is your name?'. Below the text area is the 'Identify' section with a dropdown menu showing 'Multiple choice options'. Underneath is the 'Options for user' section with a '+ New option' button. At the bottom is the 'Save user response as' section with a dropdown menu showing '{x}', 'Var1', and 'choice'.

Store response in variable: **EmployeeName**

Configuration

Setting	Value
Question	What is your name?
Identify	User's entire response

Save user response as	EmployeeName (string)
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The screenshot shows the Microsoft Bot Framework Designer interface. On the left, a workflow is visible with three nodes: a topic node, a message node, and a question node. The message node is selected, and its properties are shown on the right. The question node is also visible below the message node.

Variable properties

Variable name: EmployeeName

Type: string

Reference: Question (***What is your name?**) Type (string) derived from here Variable gets value from this node if empty

[View all references](#)

Usage: ☒ Topic (limited scope) ☐ Receive values from other topics ☐ Return values to original topics ☐ Global (any topic can access)

Sensitive data: ☐ Off

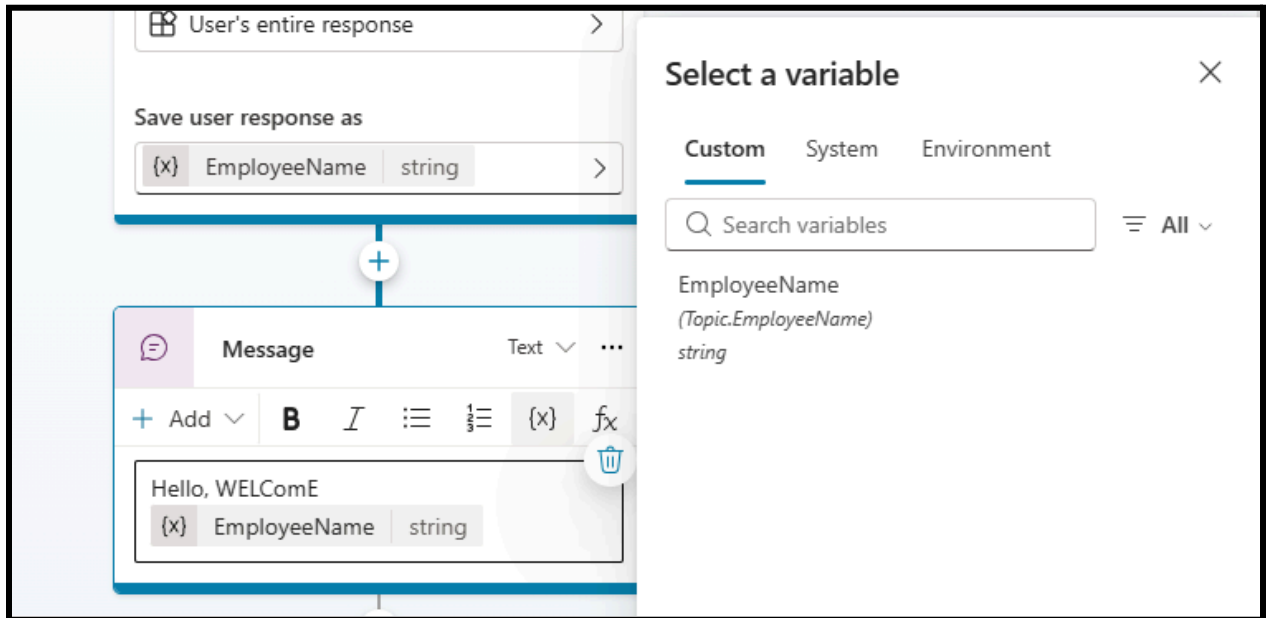
After the **"What is your name?"** question, click +.

1. Select **Send a message**.
2. In the message box, type: **Hello**

3. Click the **{x} Variables** button in the toolbar



4. Click on **EmployeeName** listed under **Topic variables**.



In the message box, type:

Hello {EmployeeName}, welcome to the Microsoft Training Registration Assistant.

Task 6: Test the Topic

Use the Test Agent panel:

User: Register for training

Expected Conversation:

Bot: Welcome to the Microsoft Training Registration Assistant.

Bot: What is your name?

User: Sourabh Taneja

Bot: Hello Sourabh Taneja, welcome to the Microsoft Training Registration Assistant.

Challenge Exercise (Later - After the session)

Enhance the topic by:

- Asking for preferred training date
- Adding a confirmation step